

April

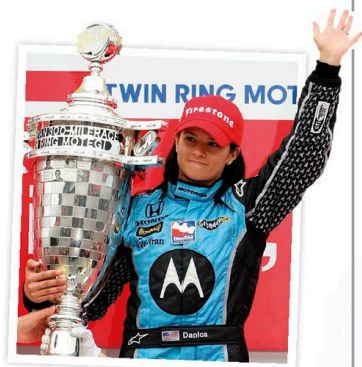
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Born this day

1964 Andy Serkis, British film and voice actor, director, and motion capture artist. He is famous for portraying Gollum in *The Lord of the Rings*.

Triumph in Japan

Claiming victory at Indy Japan 300, US racing driver Danica Patrick became the first woman to win an IndyCar Series race. She took the lead from the top contenders in the final few laps of the 200-lap race.



2008

2010

Disaster at sea

An explosion on *Deepwater Horizon*, an oil drilling rig off the coast of Louisiana, USA, caused an enormous fire and the death of 11 workers. Two days later, the rig sank, causing the world's worst-ever oil spill, which devastated many marine wildlife species.

1961

Human rocket

In a pioneering 13-second flight, US engineer Harold Graham became the first person to be lifted off the ground by a jet propulsion device without being tethered. He rose 1.2 m (4 ft) into the air.



Also on this day

1611 English playwright William Shakespeare's tragedy *Macbeth* was performed for the first time at the Globe Theatre in London, England.

1862 French chemist Louis Pasteur and biologist Claude Bernard first tested their new method for preserving liquids such as milk.

